

CTF Write-up: Travellers

Category: OSINT • Open Source Intelligence Investigation

Challenge Overview

This challenge required the use of OSINT (Open Source Intelligence) techniques to identify a location from an image and determine the exact meeting point used by a hacktivist group called “**Travellers.**”

Objective: Identify the building shown in the image and locate the “nearest island” where the group planned to meet.

- **Target:** Travellers hacktivist group
- **Goal:** Identify the meeting location
- **Flag Format:** SK-CERT{Name_of_the_island}

Phase 1: Image Analysis & Geolocation

The provided image, `travellers_part1.jpg`, showed a modern building with several distinctive architectural elements:

- Large glass curtain walls
- A prominent cantilevered roof structure
- Visible Glulam wooden support beams
- High-tech classroom interiors visible through the glass

These unique features made the structure highly recognizable.

By performing reverse image searches and using search terms such as:

`modern construction college building wood beams Canada`

the building was identified as the:

Algonquin Centre for Construction Excellence (ACCE)

Algonquin College – Woodroffe Campus

Ottawa, Ontario, Canada

Location Details

`1385 Woodroffe Ave,`
`Nepean, ON K2G 1V8,`
`Canada`

The architecture matched the provided image perfectly, confirming the geolocation.

Phase 2: Identifying the “Nearest Island”

The challenge description mentioned that the group was “supposed to meet on the nearest island.”

Since the image had already been geolocated, the next step was analyzing the surrounding area using:

- Google Maps
- Satellite imagery
- Local geographic landmarks

Step 1 — Scan Nearby Area

The area surrounding the ACCE building was inspected using satellite view.

Step 2 — Identify Local Landmark

Directly across Woodroffe Avenue lies **Centrepointe Park**.

Step 3 — Analyze Water Features

Inside the park is a small man-made pond called **Centrepointe Pond**.

Step 4 — Discover the Island

In the middle of the pond is a small landmass connected by a bridge. This island is officially named:

Point Island

Phase 3: Verification

Additional checks were performed to ensure the location fit the challenge logic.

- **Distance:** Point Island is approximately 600 meters from the ACCE building, making it the nearest identifiable island.
- **Accessibility:** The island is reachable within a short walking distance.
- **Challenge Theme:** In OSINT and hacker-themed challenges, “meeting on the nearest island” often refers to a local secluded landmark rather than a large geographic island.
- **Uniqueness:** Point Island was the only true island-like feature within the immediate vicinity.

Final Solution

Based on the geolocation analysis and surrounding landmarks, the hacktivist meeting point was determined to be:

SK-CERT{Point_Island}

Conclusion

This challenge demonstrated classic OSINT methodology:

- Architectural recognition
- Reverse image searching
- Geolocation using satellite imagery
- Environmental analysis and deduction

Rather than relying on technical exploitation, the challenge focused on careful observation and logical reasoning.